



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

aṣṭāṅgo 'ṣṭādaśapadaḥ śataśākhas tathā-eva ca | Māṭṛkā 01.009a
triyonir dvyabhiyogaś ca dvidvāro dvigatis tathā || 9 || Māṭṛkā 01.009c
dharmaś ca vyavahāraś ca caritraṃ rājaśāsanam | Māṭṛkā 01.010a
catuṣpād vyavahāro 'yam uttaraḥ pūrvabādhakaḥ || 10 || Māṭṛkā 01.010c

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 1, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Nāradaśmṛti opens a doorway into understanding the intricate dance of dharma, law, and societal conduct, offering a framework that, while ancient, resonates with profound relevance even in your modern world. The passage speaks of a structure, "aṣṭāṅgo 'ṣṭādaśapadaḥ śataśākhas tathā-eva ca," describing it as having eight parts, eighteen titles, and a hundred branches. This alludes to the vast and multifaceted nature of legal and ethical considerations. It is a reminder that navigating life's complexities requires a holistic approach, considering different angles and perspectives.

The text further describes the legal process with terms like "triyonir dvyabhiyogaś ca dvidvāro dvigatis tathā," implying three sources, two pleas, two entrances, and two outcomes. This highlights the layered and potentially conflicting nature of truth and justice. It suggests that reaching a resolution involves a journey through multiple viewpoints and potential pitfalls. "Dharmaś ca vyavahāraś ca caritraṃ rājaśāsanam" then clarifies the core elements: dharma (righteous conduct), vyavahāra (legal procedure), caritra (custom), and rājaśāsanam (royal decree). These pillars form the foundation upon which societal harmony rests.

Finally, "catuṣpād vyavahāro 'yam uttaraḥ pūrvabādhakaḥ" introduces the concept of a four-legged legal process where a later argument can override a previous one. This dynamic nature of justice acknowledges the importance of ongoing evaluation and adaptation. It's a call for you to remain open to new information and perspectives, even if they challenge your existing beliefs. In your daily life, this translates to approaching conflicts with empathy, seeking to understand the multiple facets of a situation before passing judgment. The wisdom lies in recognizing that truth is often a process, not a fixed point, and that justice requires a constant re-evaluation of facts and principles.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you apply the principle of "uttaraḥ pūrvabādhakaḥ" in your own life to remain flexible and open-minded in the face of new information or changing circumstances?